

How the trainer framed sitting the certification exam

Claude Certified Developer, Foundation (CCDV-F) · UST masterclass

EN

Session 10 of 12 · English notes

Before lecture started, Arvind said his Foundation sitting was **30 August 2026** and asked when the cohort would cover *how to attempt* the exam — only three classes remained that week. Vijay answered: **today, in the second part**. The recording then filled with tool use, MCP, and a RAG teaser. Treat this chapter as the *framing* from 24 August, and module 12 as the sitting tactics and Skilljar map.

What was promised versus what fitted in the clock

The trainer did not walk a full proctor checklist on 24 August. He did keep repeating an exam filter while teaching tools: some API knobs are real in production and still **out of scope for Foundation**. The explicit example was streaming **tool_choice** / beta paths — useful later, “this doesn’t come up in our exams.” That is the sitting posture: you are tested on the stable handshake (schema, stop reason, tool_result, MCP roles), not every beta flag in a notebook.

PERCENTAGES AND UI CHANGE

Weightings Vijay quoted from Skilljar on 27 August (module 12) can move. Register and read the live exam guide on [Anthropic Academy](#) and current [docs.claude.com](#) pages.

How he wanted you to think while answering

- Foundation is a **developer concepts** exam: MCQ plus written scenarios (from earlier modules), not “open the IDE and ship an app.”
- When a stem mentions live weather, HR data, or “the model stopped because it needs a function,” the next step is a **tool or MCP server**, not stuffing the fact into the system prompt.
- When a stem mentions a thousand-page PDF and token cost, the next step is **RAG** (retrieve a few chunks), which he introduced at the end of this same session.
- When a stem mentions Figma, Gmail, or Copilot connectors, think **MCP client + vendor or first-party server**, not a one-off Python function copied into three apps.
- Prefer **specific tool descriptions** and **selective attachment** over dumping twenty overlapping tools — collision is the failure story he wanted you to recognise.

Calendar pressure the room actually had

People were already booked. The pedagogical implication: do not wait for a perfect “exam week.” Use session recordings and the Skilljar course that the trainer said his examples were drawn from. Module 12 later named **Building with the Claude API** as the large slice (~33% in his walkthrough), tools/MCP as a

dedicated slice (~10%), and AI Fluency for builders for prompting. Recheck those numbers on Skilljar before you sit.

What “attempt” meant in his language

Even before the 27 August mock-exam chat, the 24 August Q&A trained an attempt style:

1. Read whether the model is *deciding* or the app is *executing*. Mixing those up fails tool questions.
2. Ignore classroom library nicknames (“entropy”, “OHEI”) if the option names the official product (Anthropic SDK, Voyage, MongoDB Atlas, Agent SDK).
3. If two answers both “call a tool,” pick the one that returns a `tool_result` on a follow-up user message rather than inventing data in the first assistant turn.
4. Beta, leaderboards, and custom confusion-matrix tooling around tool routing were discussion, not the Foundation rubric.

Sitting logistics he deferred (preview)

On 27 August he added: timed practice (he mentioned on the order of **120 minutes** and a mix of question counts such as 53 or 23 depending on the paper you practise), mark-for-review in the proctor UI, scenario English, unofficial mock sites that are *conceptually* close but not identical items, certification validity he stated as **two years**, and first-attempt pressure. Those tactics belong in module 12 chapter 04. Do not treat a third-party mock as Anthropic’s item bank.

Study order if you sit immediately after this session

- Replay the date-time and two-tool notebooks until you can narrate stop reason → execute → tool_result without notes.
- Draw the MCP client/server diagram and the N×N problem from memory.
- Skim RAG (end of this recording + module 11) so “huge PDF” questions are not a surprise.
- Open Skilljar and the official tool-use/MCP docs the night before — not only the cohort PDF folder.

DO NOT PASTE WORK SECRETS INTO MOCKS

Practice prompts and third-party quiz sites are not a UST client sandbox. Keep proprietary text out of both Claude and unofficial exam coaches.

Official documentation

• Anthropic Academy (Skilljar)

<https://anthropic.skilljar.com>

Registration, official prep courses, and the live blueprint.

• Tool use overview

<https://docs.claude.com/en/docs/agents-and-tools/tool-use/overview>

Highest-yield API topic from this session.

- **MCP**

<https://docs.claude.com/en/docs/agents-and-tools/mcp>

Second high-yield topic if the blueprint still lists tools/MCP as a slice.

- **API overview**

<https://docs.claude.com/en/api/overview>

Orientation for “building with the Claude API” questions.

Study notes distilled from the UST CCD Foundation masterclass. Prefer Anthropic’s current docs over session anecdotes. Not official exam material.